

Unit Y308: The Catholic Reformation 1492–1610

This theme focuses on the development of the Catholic Reformation in the course of the 16th century. Learners should consider how far the movement was a Catholic or a Counter Reformation, how far it had achieved its aims by the beginning of the 17th century and assess the main influences upon its development. The strands identified below are not to be studied in isolation to each other.

Learners are not expected to demonstrate a detailed understanding of the specification content, except for the named depth studies, but are expected to know the main developments and turning points relevant to the theme.

Thematic Study: The Catholic Reformation 1492–1610	
Key Topics	Content Learners should have studied the following:
The nature of the Catholic Reformation	The condition of the Catholic Church in the 1490s; the Church's reaction to humanism and Protestantism; early attempts at reform including Savonarola, Loyola and Papal reforms; whether the revival was a Catholic or Counter Reformation; methods of reform and revival; regional variations and the response of the laity, clergy and monarchs.
Institutional reforms	The role of the Papacy; Inquisition; Index; Councils (Lateran and Trent, the decisions made and their impact); the Society of Jesus; new and traditional orders; including the capuchins; the oratory of Divine Love; the Ursulines and Theatines.
Role of individuals	The contributions to the Catholic revival of Erasmus, Cisneros, Paul III, Loyola, Charles V, Philip II, Paul IV, Pius IV, Pius V, Gregory XIII, Sixtus V, Clement VIII, Carlo Borromeo, Francis Xavier, Vincent de Paul and Teresa of Avila.
Impact of the Catholic Reformation	Comparative extent of reform and revival in Spain, France, the Netherlands, Italy, the Holy Roman Empire, Eastern Europe, South America and the Far East; opposition and obstacles to reform; the spiritual condition of the laity; artistic and literary expressions of Catholic faith and revival.

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Depth Studies	Content Learners should be aware of debates surrounding the issues outlined for each in-depth topic:
Council of Trent	Desire for reform within the Church prior to Trent; the attitude, actions and role of Paul III; circumstances leading to the first session; discussions in the first session; the role of subsequent popes and individuals in the following sessions; debate and argument at Trent; decisions made at Trent; the impact of the Tridentine decrees.
Philip II of Spain	Background of medieval inquisition and religious reform in Spain; fear of the Jews, Conversos and Moriscos; reaction towards Protestant threats and the traditional fears of heresy and 'foreigners'; reaction to humanism and illuminism; motives for religious reform; the nature and extent of his support for the Inquisition; religious policies in Spain; Philip as 'the most Catholic Monarch'.
St Bartholomew's Day Massacre	Religious reform and relations with the Huguenots prior to 1572; the causes of the massacre; the motives of those involved; the role of Catherine de' Medici; the response of the Parisians and extent of the attack; the effect of the massacre and religious tension; the religious significance of the massacre in France and Europe.